



Death of General Reynolds

Reynolds commanded the Army of the Potomac's left wing. The circumstances of his death are disputed: he may have been killed by a Southern sharpshooter or by "friendly fire" from his own side.

Corps against corps

Word now arrived that gray-clad troops were moving down from the North. These were General Ewell's Second Corps, and they were headed precisely for the flank of the Union First Corps. Before they could get there, however, the Union Eleventh Corps, under Oliver O. Howard, had arrived dusty and thirsty after a rapid march from Emmitsburg and positioned itself to support the First Corps' right. Howard deployed his brigades too far forward and dangerously stretched an already tenuous defensive line. When Ewell's divisions came on the field, General Lee, riding forward from the west, grasped the opportunity presented to him. He ordered Ewell and General A. P. Hill, in command of Third Corps, to attack in force.

Four Confederate divisions swept forward in a semicircle from the west and north, driving in the Eleventh Corps, then the First Corps. By late afternoon, both corps were in retreat through the streets of Gettysburg, the victorious Confederates hot on their heels.